sonal emotions of love or attachment to his family and friends, community or country, and is free from the psychological imperfections of selfish desires for name, fame, wealth or for anything, he can become a *Sanyāsin* and live on the charity of persons around him, who look upon him as an ideal or a perfect man and as an example for their own lives. The *Sanyāsin* is a man who has come back to the world from his quietude of retirement preparatory to spending the rest of his life in doing disinterested good to his fellowmen. He is now a citizen of the world of humanity and is therefore an ideal for all men.

This fourth *Āśrama* of the *Sanyāsin* is an institution for the Hindus. The *Sanyāsins* are their holy men and prophets and examples of what a human being can make of himself in terms of his freedom from wants and desires of any kind. In terms of wantlessness, contentment, and a serene realization of the unity of life with the rest of the creation, he is supposed to be the highest of men. These *Sanyāsins, Sādhus,* or *Swāmīs* are still respected in India. In fact, no one has a greater hold on the minds of men than these wandering mendicants, although, of the very large number of such men today, hardly a dozen are qualified to be worthy of this respect. This is the last and the final ideal of what a man ought to become, spiritually and morally, if he is not to die without having risen above the sensuous level of living. People are expected to see that no holy man is ever in need of shelter or his daily ration of food. This explains why millions of persons in India even without requisite moral or spiritual qualifications are still flourishing today under the titles of *Swāmī* and *Sādhu.* In no other culture or religion, could we have found so many millions of human beings living with perfect respectability or prestige without working for their livelihood. The idea of the four stages of life with the *Sannyāsa* as the highest stage, is a unique contribution of the Hindu religion and philosophy to the ideals of human life. The institution of the *Āśramas* which is supposed to be ideal and eternal in form, in the course of centuries, has degenerated into its mere outer form, devoid of the high spirit behind it. But it still exploits the traditional respect of the people for the *Sanyāsin,* or the renouncer, giving rise today to a large class of persons who are no better than worthless beggars. Now that the country is independent, the evil will disappear within the course of time, but one wonders if the good in it, namely, the ideal of a morally, spiritually, perfectly free and unattached man, will also not disappear with it.